

PEACE IN SYRIA

A Prayer for the Suffering

Performer: Raito Gracia

School: Cherish Academy

Event: Platform Division — Expressive Reading

Scripture: Matthew 5:9

Time Limit: 4 – 6 minutes

INTRODUCTION

(spoken before the reading — does not count toward time)

My name is Raito Gracia, representing Cherish Academy.

The piece I will present today is titled "Peace in Syria" —

a prayer for those suffering from violence, displacement, and war.

It is grounded in the words of Jesus in Matthew 5:9:

"Blessed are the peacemakers, for they shall be called children of God."

THE READING

O God of Mercy and Tender Compassion,

bring comfort to those suffering from violence

and to those mourning the dead.

Be near to the brokenhearted,

and shelter those who live in fear each day.

O God of Hope,

sustain those who labor for peaceful and just solutions.

Inspire leaders and decision makers

to choose the way of peace over the way of violence.

Grant them wisdom, courage, and humility

to seek justice and reconciliation.

Deliver all your children from the threat of war,

and teach us to encounter one another

with reverence and love.

Protect the innocent, especially the children,

and provide refuge for those who have been displaced.

We pray in the name of Jesus Christ,

who came to bring peace on earth,

and who abides with you and the Holy Spirit, now and forever.

We cry out to you in this time of crisis.

Hear the cries of the people of Syria.

Bring healing to those who are wounded

in body, mind, and spirit.

Restore what has been broken,

and let your peace rise where there has been despair.

***"Blessed are the peacemakers,
for they shall be called children of God."***

— Matthew 5:9

Raito Gracia | Cherish Academy | Accelerate Ministries Convention 2024